

Friday, 14 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

33° 23°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

31° 20°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

28° 18°

GLASGOW

Light rain

21° 16°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Heatwaves drive A&E attendances up to record high.

More than 2.4 million visits in each of last three months, as unions warn of inhumane conditions.

UK · NEWS

2

Son pays tribute to dad, 102, who died after allegedly being assaulted in pub.

Phillip Ormerod was taken to hospital in critical condition and later died, police have confirmed.

UK · NEWS

3

UK economy grows but experts warn of challenging months ahead.

Hot weather and the men's football World Cup boosted the economy but the Iran war may weigh on growth

UK · NEWS

4

Boy suffered fatal brain injury in seaside drowning.

An inquest into the deaths of Musa Ahmed, his cousin and her mother will be heard in January.

UK · NEWS

5

Harvey Nichols bought by owner of Sports Direct.

The department store made famous by sitcom Absolutely Fabulous had warned it would cease trading.

UK · NEWS

What's coming up

- 1 Eurovision Song Contest 2027 to be held in Burgas, Bulgaria.**
The Black Sea location has been selected after Bulgarian singer Dara won this year's contest.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 2 Travis Kelce shares first details from his wedding to Taylor Swift: 'Best night of my life'.**
In the comments, Kelce called Swift his "wife" for first time and said it was a "childhood dream" to wed at Madison Square Garden.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 3 Ayra Starr on her secret relationship and teasing Stevie Wonder.**
The musician shares the personal stories behind her third album, and the time she teased a legend.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 4 New indictment alleges Nick Reiner was lying in wait before killing parents Rob and Michele Reiner.**
The allegation makes Reiner eligible for the death penalty - which has been paused in the state. Prosecutors have not said if they will pursue it.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 5 BTS star V reveals hearing loss battle during livestream.**
The K-pop star says he has suffered hearing issues for over two years before revealing it publicly this week.
SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 Hodgkinson into 800m final and Werro through despite nasty fall.**
Keely Hodgkinson reaches the women's 800m final at the European Championships - moments after rival Audrey Werro suffers a dramatic fall that put her place in doubt.

SPORT · UK

- 2 Tielemans apologises to Villa fans for Man Utd remarks.**
Youri Tielemans apologises to Aston Villa fans after suggesting he had moved to a bigger club in Premier League rivals Manchester United.

SPORT · UK

- 3 Critical former referees add to culture of fear, says retiring Taylor.**
Retiring Premier League referee Anthony Taylor says his decision to quit was partly due to the toxic debate around officials.

SPORT · UK

- 4 Leicester City put up for sale for more than £200m.**
Leicester City's Thai owners King Power are hoping to sell the club after 16 years, for more than £200m.

SPORT · UK

- 5 Super League confirm NRL investment offer.**
Super League confirm that they have received an investment offer from the Australian Rugby League Commission.

SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A growing trend sees urban dwellers embracing 'micro-gardening' on balconies and windowsills.**
Residents are finding creative ways to grow herbs, vegetables, and flowers in small spaces, bringing a touch of green to city living and often sharing their bounty with neighbours.
- 2 The simple joy of 'writing and sending postcards' is making a charming comeback, particularly among holidaymakers.**
Forget emails! People are rediscovering the personal touch of a handwritten note and a scenic stamp, delighting friends and family with tangible memories from their travels.
- 3 Research suggests that 'listening to the natural sounds of rainfall' can significantly aid relaxation and sleep.**
Many find the gentle pitter-patter incredibly soothing, helping to block out distracting noises and create a peaceful atmosphere for unwinding after a busy day.
- 4 Local libraries are reporting a surge in interest for 'borrowing jigsaw puzzles', becoming community hubs for shared entertainment.**
It's a wonderful way for people to try new puzzles without buying them, fostering a sense of shared enjoyment and even leading to puzzle-swapping clubs.
- 5 The delightful art of 'picnic basket preparation' is being rediscovered, moving beyond just sandwiches.**
Families and friends are creating elaborate, themed picnic spreads with homemade treats and comfortable blankets, turning outdoor meals into special occasions.
- 6 A charming trend has emerged where people are 'leaving friendly notes for bin collectors and postal workers'.**
These small gestures of appreciation, often accompanied by a refreshing drink on a warm day, are bringing smiles and boosting community spirit.
- 7 The enduring appeal of 'traditional board games' continues to bring families together for screen-free fun.**
From classic chess to lively modern strategy games, families are enjoying quality time, laughter, and a bit of friendly competition around the kitchen table.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we open a new jar of jam or spread, even though we know it's a bit naughty?

ANSWER: HAVING A TINY TASTE STRAIGHT FROM THE SPOON, BEFORE ANYONE ELSE!

Q Our survey said that over 50% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh piece of toast. What is it?

ANSWER: INSPECTING BOTH SIDES FOR THE PERFECT LEVEL OF GOLDEN-BROWN CRISPINESS.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a particular 'smell from your childhood' can instantly transport you back in time?

What's that one specific aroma – perhaps a specific soap, a type of flower, or even the smell of a old book – that takes you straight back to being a little one?

- We all have those 'little phrases or sayings' that our grandparents or an older relative used to say, don't we, that have just stuck with us?

What's a memorable, perhaps slightly quirky, saying that you've inherited from a beloved family member, and do you ever find yourself using it now?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of ferrets is called a 'business'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that if you tickle a penguin, it will purr like a cat?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£3.5 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.5 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The distinctive red telephone boxes in the UK were designed by Sir Giles Gilbert Scott.
- The shortest commercial flight in the world is between Westray and Papa Westray in Scotland, lasting only about 90 seconds.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, specifically 1/100th of a second.
- The world's first postage stamp, the Penny Black, was issued in the United Kingdom in 1840.
- The average cloud weighs around 550 tons, roughly the same as 100 elephants.
- Wombat poo is cube-shaped, which helps it not roll away from their territory markers.
- The Great Fire of London in 1666 actually helped to eradicate the Black Death plague by killing the rats and fleas.
- The game of bingo was originally called 'Beano' because players marked their cards with beans.

On this day

Day 226 of the year, 139 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Arnold of Soissons; Christian feast day: Domingo Ibáñez de Erquicia; Christian feast day: Eusebius of Rome; Christian feast day: Fachtna of Rosscarbery. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1984 — Nicola Slater, Scottish tennis player
- 1984 — Nick Grimshaw, English radio and television host
- 1926 — Buddy Greco, American singer and pianist (died 2017)
- 1946 — Susan Saint James, American actress
- 1947 — Maddy Prior, English folk singer
- 1945 — Steve Martin, American actor, comedian, musician, producer, and screenwriter
- 1983 — Elena Baltacha, Ukrainian-Scottish tennis player (died 2014)
- 1946 — Antonio Fargas, American actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 1941 — World War II: Winston Churchill and Franklin D. Roosevelt sign the Atlantic Charter of war stating postwar aims.
- 1980 — Lech Wałęsa leads strikes at the Gdańsk, Poland shipyards.
- 2007 — The Kahtaniya bombings kill at least 500 people.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1980 — Lech Wałęsa leads strikes at the Gdańsk, Poland shipyards.
- 1959 — Founding and first official meeting of the American Football League.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1996 — Greek Cypriot refugee Solomos Solomou is shot and killed by a Turkish security officer while trying to climb a flagpole in order to remove a Turkish flag from its mast in the United Nations Buffer Zone in Cyprus.
- 1994 — Ilich Ramírez Sánchez, also known as "Carlos the Jackal", is captured.

- 2022 — An explosion destroys a market in Armenia, killing six people and injuring dozens.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 227 of the year, 138 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (Poland); Christian feast day: Altfrid; Christian feast day: Alypius of Thagaste; Christian feast day: Feast day of the Assumption of Mary, one of the Catholic holy days of obligation (a public holiday in Austria, Belgium, Benin, Bosnia, Burundi, Cameroon, Chile, Colombia, Croatia, Cyprus, France, some states in Germany, Greece, Guatemala, Italy, Ivory Coast, Lebanon, Liechtenstein, Lithuania, Luxembourg, Madagascar, Malta, Mauritius, Paraguay, Poland, Portugal, Romania, Senegal, Seychelles, Slovenia, Spain, Switzerland, Togo, and Vanuatu); and its related observances: Feast of the Dormition of the Theotokos (Eastern Orthodox, Oriental Orthodox and Eastern Catholic Churches). Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1989 — Carlos PenaVega, American actor and singer
- 1961 — Matt Johnson, English singer-songwriter and musician
- 1951 — Bobby Caldwell, American singer-songwriter (died 2023)
- 1983 — Siobhan Chamberlain, English association football goalkeeper
- 1967 — Peter Hermann, American actor
- 1970 — Anthony Anderson, American comedian, actor, and producer
- 1993 — Alex Oxlade-Chamberlain, English footballer
- 1990 — Jennifer Lawrence, American actress and producer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2015 — North Korea moves its clock back half an hour to introduce Pyongyang Time, ⁸/₂ hours ahead of UTC.
- 1998 — Northern Ireland: Omagh bombing takes place; 29 people (including a woman pregnant with twins) killed and some 220 others injured.
- 2005 — Israel's unilateral disengagement plan to evict all Israelis from the Gaza Strip and from four settlements in the northern West Bank begins.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1882 — Start of the second part of the Montceau-les-Mines troubles by the Black Band, groups of anarchist miners.
- 1976 — SAETA Flight 011 crashes into the Chimborazo volcano in Ecuador, killing all 59 people on board; the wreckage is not discovered until 2002.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

SAT 15 Premier League season begins (2026/27)

22–23 Belgian Grand Prix (F1)